

FIELD GUIDE FG-001

THE CODE DUNGEON - A D&D AD- VENTURE

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THE CODE DUNGEON

A D&D 5E ADVENTURE

ADVENTURE OVERVIEW

Level: 3-5

Party Size: 3-5 players

Duration: 2-3 hours

Theme: Programming, debugging, technical debt

BACKGROUND

The party has been hired to investigate a mysterious dungeon that appeared overnight in the middle of the city. The dungeon is actually a corrupted codebase, and the party must navigate through bug-infested code, refactor ancient functions, and defeat the final boss: The Legacy System.

THE ENTRANCE: THE MAIN FUNCTION

The adventure begins at the entrance to the dungeon - a massive function called `main()`. It's 500 lines long and does everything.

Encounter: The party must refactor this function into smaller, manageable pieces. Each successful refactoring grants XP and reveals the path forward.

ROOM 1: THE INFINITE LOOP

A circular room where the party finds themselves walking in circles. The walls are covered in code that loops endlessly.

Puzzle: The party must find the exit condition that's missing from the loop. Success requires a DC 15 Intelligence check.

Reward: 100 XP, +1 to debugging skills

ROOM 2: THE MEMORY LEAK

A room that grows smaller every round. The party must escape before the room collapses.

Encounter: The party has 5 rounds to find and fix the memory leak. Each round, the room shrinks, dealing 1d4 damage to everyone inside.

Solution: Find the variable that's never being freed and add proper cleanup code.

Reward: 150 XP, Memory Leak Protection (resistance to memory-based attacks)

ROOM 3: THE NULL POINTER

A dark room where nothing exists. The party must create something from nothing.

Puzzle: The party must write code that handles null values properly. Requires a DC 18 Wisdom check (understanding edge cases).

Reward: 200 XP, Null Safety (advantage on saves against null pointer exceptions)

THE FINAL BOSS: THE LEGACY SYSTEM

A massive, ancient system that's been running for years without updates. It's slow, buggy, and resistant to change.

Stats:

- **HP:** 200
- **AC:** 18 (legacy code is hard to change)
- **Attacks:** Technical Debt (2d8 damage), Outdated Dependencies (1d6 damage)

Special Abilities:

- **Resistance to Refactoring:** Takes half damage from refactoring attempts
- **Summon Bugs:** Can summon 1d4 bugs per turn
- **Legacy Code:** Can't be easily replaced (advantage on saves)

Defeat Condition: The party must refactor the legacy system into modern, maintainable code. This requires:

1. Writing comprehensive tests (DC 20)
2. Breaking it into smaller modules (DC 18)
3. Updating dependencies (DC 15)
4. Documenting the changes (DC 12)

Reward: 500 XP, Legacy System Slayer title, +2 to all programming skills

CONCLUSION

With the legacy system defeated, the codebase is clean, modern, and maintainable. The party has saved the city from technical debt and earned the gratitude of developers everywhere.

May your code be bug-free and your tests always pass!